

CELEBRATION

A festival atmosphere bubbles through Persepolis—it is Nowruz, the New Year celebration, and hundreds of people have brought tribute to the emperor. The city is crowded and noisy, it bustles with people and animals from across the empire. Persian officials oversee the excitement as the visitors wait to enter the Apadana.



Strength of a bull
Persian columns were often topped with decorative creatures, such as lions, griffins, and bulls. Bulls were one of the most common choices—perhaps because they represent strength. The back of the bull helped support the weight of the roof.

A pattern of swirls adorns the bull's chest



This horn is decorated with the snarling head of a lion.

Drinking horn

Nowruz was a lively event and a time for celebration. Some of Persepolis's visitors might have used the time to enjoy a drink from a *rhyton*, an elaborate drinking horn.

Living gifts

Carvings at Persepolis show that people brought animals from all over the Persian Empire as tribute. This frieze shows Bactrians from Central Asia with a camel to present to the emperor.



Chariots and roads

The Persians used chariots on an extensive network of roads they built to help them control their enormous territory and move soldiers and goods quickly and easily from one place to another. This tiny golden figurine of a chariot shows a local governor visiting a province under his control.

Four horses pull the chariot



This figure is thought to be a *satrap*—a local governor.

